予 想 問 題　第 2 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

山形大学（人文社会科学部・医学部ほか 英語を課す学部の共通問題）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜6ページ・解答用紙 7〜8ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は90分。大問は Ⅰ・Ⅱ の2題で，英文は2本。設問の指示は英語で書かれている。
3. 日本語で答える設問（和訳・字数指定の説明）と，英語で答える設問（英作文など）がある。
4. 配点は Ⅰ 100点・Ⅱ 100点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
5. 本冊子の英文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

山形大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（記事）（配点 100点）

Go through the passage, then answer Q1 to Q5.

Borrow a Drill, Return It on Tuesday

① In a former shoe shop on the high street of Penwarren, the shelves are lined not with books but with drills, ladders, tents, sewing machines and a machine for cleaning carpets. Each item carries a small label with a number, a photograph and a short list of what it can be used for. Members can borrow up to three things at a time for one week, and the only rule printed above the counter is: “Bring it back clean, and tell us if it broke.”

② The tool library, as it is called, opened four years ago. Its founder, Ewan Treloar, says the idea came to him when he needed to put up a single shelf in his flat. “I went to buy a drill and realised I would use it for ten minutes and then keep it in a cupboard for years,” he says. “Most people already own several things like that. The average drill, people say, is used for only a few minutes in its whole life. (is / what / most / need / we) not a drill but a hole in the wall.”

③ Membership costs a small amount each year, and people on low incomes can join free. The library now has around 1,400 members and more than 900 items, almost all of them donated by local people who had things they no longer used. Volunteers check each item before it goes back on the shelf, and a retired engineer comes in on Saturday mornings to repair anything that has stopped working.

④ For many members, the main attraction is money. A family that wants to go camping for one weekend does not have to buy a tent, sleeping bags and a stove; a student moving into a new flat can borrow a ladder and a set of paint rollers. But Treloar argues that the library offers something more than savings. By sharing objects that most people use only occasionally, a town can reduce the number of things that are made, shipped and eventually thrown away.

⑤ Some economists are less enthusiastic. They point out that if everyone borrowed instead of buying, shops that sell tools would suffer, and so would the people who work in them. Treloar is not worried about this. “We are tiny,” he says. “And many of our members go on to buy the tools they find they really need. They just buy them more carefully, because they have tried them first.”

⑥ The library has also had effects that nobody planned. Because members collect and return items in person, the counter has become a place where people swap advice. Someone returning a lawnmower explains how to sharpen its blade; someone borrowing a sewing machine is shown how to thread it by a stranger who happens to be waiting. On Thursday evenings the library runs free repair sessions, and these are now so popular that people have to book a place weeks ahead.

⑦ Not every item comes back in perfect condition. Treloar estimates that about one borrowing in fifty ends with something broken or missing, usually a small part such as a tent peg* or the key for a ladder. The library does not charge for accidents. “If we fined people every time something went wrong, they would stop telling us,” he says. “Honesty is more useful to us than a few pounds.” Members who damage something are simply asked to explain what happened, so that the volunteers can fix it or warn the next borrower.

⑧ There are practical limits, too. Some things are simply too large, too dangerous or too expensive to lend, and the library has decided not to stock chainsaws or anything that needs special training. Space is another problem: the shop is full, and popular items such as carpet cleaners often have a waiting list of several weeks. The library hopes to open a second, smaller branch in a village a few miles away, where many older residents struggle to travel into town.

⑨ Similar libraries now exist in a number of countries, and some of them lend things that Treloar had never considered, from cake tins and party decorations to musical instruments and board games. What they share is a modest but surprisingly powerful idea: that a community can own some things together rather than separately.

⑩ Treloar admits that he still owns a drill. A member gave it to him as a joke when the library celebrated its third birthday. “It is in my cupboard,” he says, smiling. “I have used it twice.”

Word notes

peg　（テントを固定する）くい，ペグ

Questions

Q1 Rearrange the words in the bracketed, underlined part of paragraph ② so that the sentence makes sense.

is / what / most / need / we

Q2 Render the underlined part of paragraph ④ in natural Japanese.

Q3 For each underlined word below, pick the option from (A) to (D) whose meaning is nearest.

(1) ***enthusiastic*** in paragraph ⑤

(A) worried　(B) eager　(C) honest　(D) curious

(2) ***book*** in paragraph ⑥

(A) read　(B) write　(C) reserve　(D) cancel

(3) ***modest*** in paragraph ⑨

(A) huge　(B) strange　(C) recent　(D) humble

Q4 What point is the writer making about the counter in paragraph ⑥?

(A) It is where members must pay a fine for broken items.

(B) It is closed on Thursday evenings for repairs.

(C) It is too small for the number of members who visit.

(D) It has unexpectedly become a place for sharing practical tips.

Q5 In Japanese, explain why Treloar makes the underlined remark in paragraph ⑦. Use 50 to 60 characters.

II 長文読解（記事）（配点 100点）

Go through the passage, then answer Q1 to Q4.

The Quiet Return of the Public Fountain

① For most of the twentieth century, the city of Ostbridge was full of public drinking fountains. There was one at almost every tram stop, in every park and outside the main railway station, where travellers would bend down for a mouthful of cold water before their journey. Then, one by one, they disappeared. Pipes leaked, repairs were expensive, and as bottled water became cheap and simple to buy, the city decided that the fountains were no longer worth the trouble.

② Now they are coming back. In the last three years, Ostbridge has installed more than sixty new fountains, and many of them look quite different from the old stone basins. Most have two taps: a low one for drinking and a higher one for filling bottles. Some show a small counter that tells users how many plastic bottles the fountain has helped to save. The one outside the central library has already passed forty thousand.

③ The idea came [a] a group of secondary school students who were studying waste in their geography class. They collected the plastic bottles thrown away in one small park over a single weekend and found more than three hundred. When they presented their results [b] the city council, they asked a simple question: if people could refill a bottle for free, would they still buy a new one every time they felt thirsty? The council agreed to install five fountains [c] a trial basis and to count how often they were used.

④ The results surprised almost everyone. During the first hot summer, the five fountains were used more than two thousand times a day in total. Shop owners near one of them noticed fewer empty bottles [d] the gutters, and a nearby café began offering to refill customers' bottles at no charge. Encouraged, the council decided to spread the fountains [e] the whole city, concentrating first on parks, schools and the routes most popular with runners and cyclists.

⑤ Supporters say the benefits go beyond reducing litter. On very hot days, free water can protect the health of people who work outdoors, of older residents and of those who cannot easily afford to buy drinks. "A fountain is among the few things in a city that are useful to everyone and cost the user nothing," says Ilse Marken, a council officer who manages the scheme. "It does not ask who you are or whether you have any money."

⑥ Not everyone is convinced. Some residents worry about hygiene, and say they would never put their mouth near a tap that thousands of strangers have used. The council responded by choosing designs in which the water rises in an arc, so that nobody needs to touch the spout

*, and by testing the water at each fountain every week. The results are published online, and so far every test has met the national standard.

⑦ Cost is another concern. Each fountain must be connected to the water supply, protected against freezing in winter and cleaned regularly. Critics on the council have argued that the money would be better spent on other services. Marken accepts that the fountains are not free to run, but argues that they should be compared with the cost of collecting and disposing of the bottles they replace. “Somebody always pays for plastic,” she says. “The only question is whether we pay at the beginning or at the end.”

⑧ Perhaps the hardest thing to change is habit. Many people, particularly younger adults, grew up assuming that drinking water comes in a bottle from a shop. To encourage them, the city has worked with local schools to give every new pupil a reusable bottle, and an app now shows the location of every fountain on a map. The students whose project began the scheme are now at university, but two of them still help to update the map in their free time.

⑨ Ostbridge is not alone. A number of cities in different countries have started to bring back public water, sometimes in the same places where their old fountains once stood. For Marken, this is not simply a return to the past. “The old fountains were built because clean water was precious,” she says. “The new ones are being built because we have learned that throwing things away is expensive too.”

Word notes

spout （水の）出口，注ぎ口

Questions

Q1 Fill blanks [a] to [e] in paragraphs ③ and ④ using the words listed below. Use each word no more than once; one word will be left over.

across / at / from / in / on / to

Q2 Pick two statements that agree with the passage.

(A) The fountains were removed mainly because people complained about the taste of the water.

(B) Students counted the bottles left in a park over one weekend.

(C) Every new fountain has only one tap, which is used for both drinking and filling bottles.

(D) Water at each fountain is tested every week, and the results can be seen online.

(E) Marken believes the fountains cost nothing to run.

(F) The students who started the project no longer take any part in it.

Q3 In Japanese, explain Marken’s point in the underlined part of paragraph ⑦. Use 60 to 70 characters.

Q4 Do you usually carry your own water bottle when you go out? Describe your habit and give your reasons in 40 to 50 English words.

解答用紙　予想問題 第2回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。記号は (A) のように書く。

I

Q1

Q2

Q3

(1)	(2)	(3)

Q4　［　　］

Q5

60字（20字×3行，10字ごとに太線）

II

Q1

[a]	[b]	[c]	[d]	[e]

Q2　［　　］

Q3

80字（20字×4行，10字ごとに太線）

II　Q4（40 to 50 English words）

20語

40語

60語

奥付

予想問題 第2回　英語　問題

対象：山形大学 前期日程 英語（人文社会科学部・医学部ほか 英語を課す学部の共通問題）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年11月）

作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・分量・難易度を分析し，英文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

> **山形大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

本冊子の英文は実在の記事・書籍・論文・統計からの引用・翻案ではありません。登場する人物・団体・地名・数値は架空です。無断転載・再配布を禁じます。